

# Petition 4 — Special Status and Pollution-Category Parity for the Coir (De-fibring & Pith) Industry in Chittur

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**To:** Shri P.K. Kunhalikutty Hon'ble Minister for Industries & Commerce, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

**Copy to:** 1. Shri Ramesh Chennithala, Hon'ble Minister in charge of Coir 2. The Chairman, Kerala State Pollution Control Board

**From:** The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

**Through:** Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

**Date:** 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

**Subject:** Request for special status and pollution-category parity for coir de-fibring and coir-pith processing units in Chittur, so that the coir industry can develop within Kerala instead of migrating across the border to Pollachi (Tamil Nadu).

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## 1. Respected Sir,

Chittur adjoins the Pollachi belt of Tamil Nadu and has abundant coconut and coir-husk availability. Yet the primary coir-processing industry has migrated almost entirely to Pollachi, chiefly because of a **difference in pollution-control classification** between the two States. We pray for a level playing field.

## 2. The factual position

- 1. The classification gap.** The primary coir processes — **coconut-husk retting, de-fibring, and coir-pith processing** — are treated far more stringently by the Kerala State Pollution Control Board (historically in the **Red / Orange** category) than in Tamil Nadu. In **October 2023 the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board withdrew its earlier "Orange" reclassification and retained coir husk-retting, de-fibring and pith-processing in the "White" (practically non-polluting) category.**
- 2. The consequence.** Because of this gap, the **polluting / primary processes (de-fibring, pith buffering) are carried out in Pollachi**, while only value-addition (mats, yarn, mattings, geotextiles) is done in Kerala. Coir entrepreneurs — including many from Kerala — have set up primary units in Pollachi, taking away investment, jobs and the value of our own coconut husk.
- 3. CPCB norms actually permit a lighter category.** The **CPCB Directions dated 07-03-2016** (No. B-29012/ESS(CPA)/2015-16), issued under **Section 18(1)(b) of the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974**, harmonised the classification on a **Pollution Index (PI)** basis — **Red (PI ≥ 60), Orange (41–59), Green (21–40), White (≤ 20)** — and this has been carried forward by the **CPCB Directions dated 12-02-2025**. Under this methodology and the current classification, coir is placed at a **much lighter category than Red**: - Coir **fibre / pith processing generating effluent** — **Green**; - Coir fibre / pith processing and manufacture of coir products by **dry process** — **White**; - Only coir **bleaching / dyeing / printing** — **Orange**.

For comparison, the **TNPCB Board Proceedings dated 10-11-2021** briefly moved coir from White to Orange, but this was **withdrawn in 2023**, retaining coconut-husk retting, de-fibring and pith-processing in the **White** category in Tamil Nadu. In other words, a blanket Red/Orange treatment of ordinary de-fibring and dry pith processing in Kerala is **stricter than the CPCB norm requires**, and the Kerala State Pollution Control Board can align (under the same 2016/2025 Directions) without diluting genuine environmental safeguards.

## 3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister, in coordination with the Coir portfolio and the Kerala State Pollution Control Board, to:

1. **Re-align the pollution-category of coir de-fibring and dry coir-pith processing** in Kerala to **Green / White**, consistent with the CPCB 2016 methodology and the 2023/2025 classification, so that such units are viable in Chittur while dyeing/bleaching alone remains regulated.
2. Grant **special coir-cluster / coir industrial-zone status for Chittur**, with a Special Purpose Vehicle and a **Common Facility Centre** (mechanised de-fibring, pith washing / block-making with **Zero-Liquid-Discharge and effluent / salinity management**), so that environmental concerns are addressed collectively and cost-effectively.
3. Provide **fiscal incentives** — capital subsidy, interest subvention, and **power-tariff parity with Tamil Nadu** — to attract coir units to Chittur.
4. Ensure a **level playing field with Pollachi** so that the value addition to Kerala's own coconut husk is retained within Kerala, generating local employment.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Comparative note — KSPCB vs. TNPCB coir classification and CPCB norms.
- Annexure B: Estimated husk availability and employment potential in Chittur.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA  
Abstract

Industries Department — Coir sector in Chittur (Palakkad) — Alignment of the pollution-category of coir de-fibring and dry coir-pith processing with the CPCB Directions, and grant of special coir-cluster status with a Common Facility Centre — Orders issued.

INDUSTRIES (COIR) DEPARTMENT  
G.O.(Ms) No. \_\_\_\_/2026/ID      Thiruvananthapuram, dated \_\_-\_\_-2026

Read: 1. CPCB Directions dated 07-03-2016 (No. B-29012/ESS(CPA)/2015-16) u/s 18(1)(b) of the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974, and CPCB Directions dated 12-02-2025.  
2. TNPCB proceedings dated 10-11-2021 and their withdrawal (2023).  
3. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas the primary coir processes (husk retting, de-fibring, dry pith processing) are treated more stringently in Kerala than the CPCB PI-based norm requires, causing these units and their employment to migrate to Pollachi (Tamil Nadu), where they are in the White category;

Government, having considered the matter, hereby order that —

(1) the Kerala State Pollution Control Board shall re-align the category of coir de-fibring and dry coir-pith processing to Green/White, consistent with the CPCB Directions read above (1), retaining regulation only for bleaching/dyeing;  
(2) a special coir-cluster / coir industrial-zone status is accorded to

Chittur, with an SPV and a Common Facility Centre (mechanised de-fibring, pith washing/block-making with Zero-Liquid-Discharge and salinity management);

(3) capital subsidy, interest subvention and power-tariff parity with Tamil Nadu shall be extended to coir units in Chittur; and

(4) the Industries and Coir Directorates shall ensure a level playing field so that value addition to Kerala's coconut husk is retained within the State.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Director of Industries & Commerce; the Director of Coir Development; the Chairman, Kerala State Pollution Control Board.

Copy to: the Minister for Coir; Environment Dept.; the MLA, Chittur.